

Satisfactory Academic Progress Policy for Financial Aid

1. Overview

Federal regulations (34 CFR 668.34) require that students receiving financial aid make Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP) toward their degree. Westbrook University evaluates SAP at the end of each fall and spring semester.

2. SAP Standards

2.1 Qualitative Standard (GPA)

Undergraduate students must maintain a cumulative GPA of at least 2.0. Graduate students must maintain a cumulative GPA of at least 3.0.

2.2 Quantitative Standard (Pace)

Students must successfully complete at least 67% of all credit hours attempted. Incomplete grades, withdrawals, and failures count as attempted but not completed.

2.3 Maximum Time Frame

Students may not receive aid for more than 150% of the published length of their degree program. For a 120-credit bachelor's degree, the maximum is 180 attempted credit hours.

3. Consequences of Failing SAP

Students who fail to meet SAP standards are placed on Financial Aid Warning for one semester, during which aid continues. If SAP standards are not met by the end of the Warning semester, the student is placed on Financial Aid Suspension and aid is discontinued.

4. SAP Appeal

Students on Financial Aid Suspension may appeal by submitting a SAP Appeal Form to the Financial Aid Office with documentation of extenuating circumstances (injury, illness, family emergency) and an Academic Plan signed by their advisor. See Financial Aid Appeals (FIN-AID-005).